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Weekly Newsletter 2026-W06

Motivating Underperforming Students Through Conversation



★ Introduction

Every classroom has students who struggle—not because they lack ability, but because they lack confidence, motivation, or emotional support. Marks and discipline alone rarely solve this challenge. Often, what underperforming students need most is a meaningful conversation.

A simple, honest conversation can help teachers understand the root cause of a student's struggle and rebuild trust, confidence, and interest in learning. This newsletter shares practical conversation-based strategies that help teachers motivate underperforming students and guide them toward progress.

Why Conversation Matters

Positive teacher–student conversations:

- Build trust and emotional safety
- Reveal hidden challenges (fear, stress, self-doubt)
- Boost confidence and self-belief
- Improve engagement and performance
- Strengthen teacher–student relationships

When teachers listen, underperforming students begin to believe in themselves

✦ Effective Conversation Strategies

1. Listen Without Judging

Start by listening, not correcting.

- Maintain eye contact
- Avoid interrupting
- Show empathy

Sometimes, students open up only when they feel safe.



2. Ask the Right Questions



Use gentle, open-ended questions:

- “What do you find difficult in this subject?”
- “How do you feel during class?”
- “What support would help you?”

These questions encourage reflection instead of fear.

3. Begin With Positives

Highlight strengths before discussing challenges:

- Effort
- Small improvements
- Talents beyond academics

This builds confidence and willingness to improve.



Did You Know?

Students who feel emotionally connected to their teachers are more motivated and engaged, even if they struggle academically.

✦ Turning Conversations into Action

1. Set Small, Achievable Goals

Instead of saying “Improve your marks”, try:

- “Let’s focus on completing homework this week”
- “Let’s improve one topic at a time”

Small wins create momentum.



2. Make Students Part of the Plan

Ask students:

- “What goal do you want to achieve?”
- “How can I support you?”

Ownership increases commitment.



3. Follow Up Regularly

Short follow-up conversations show care:

- “How’s your progress?”
- “What’s working for you?”

Consistency builds trust and accountability.



Handling Resistance or Silence

- Stay calm and patient
- Give time—don’t force conversation
- Try informal settings (after class, during activities)

Some students need time before opening up.



Here are some reference links to empower your knowledge and deepen your understanding

- <https://vikaasa.org/how-to/motivate-underperforming-students>
- <https://motivationerds.com/motivate-an-underperforming-student/>

Watch this quick video to grasp the concept -

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QBHSo-TBvJ4>

Latest Education Update

New AI-Based Learning Initiative Launched in Himachal Pradesh

Key Highlights of Padhai with AI

- Launch Date & Location: February 5, 2026, at Barthin, Bilaspur district.
- Launched By: Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu.
- Target Audience: Students in Bilaspur preparing for competitive exams.
- Platform Features:
 - AI-driven personalized learning modules.
 - Digital resources tailored to exam preparation.
 - Focus on accessibility and equal opportunities for all students.
- Government Vision:
 - Education is seen as a tool for social change, not just syllabus completion.
 - The initiative aims to broaden thinking, shape future generations, and strengthen the education system through innovation.



Inspirational Teachers' Story



**Chandresh Kumar
Bolashankar
Borisagar**

Chandresh Kumar Bolashankar Borisagar, a dedicated teacher from Amreli district, Gujarat, has transformed the way children experience learning. Known for his creativity, he turned what many students found “boring” into something joyful and memorable.

He used folk songs and music as tools to spread educational awareness, even adapting popular Gujarati songs to encourage children to attend school regularly. His innovative approach breathed life into classrooms, making lessons engaging and culturally resonant.

Chandresh’s passion for education went beyond the classroom he composed and sang songs in 20 different languages to promote literacy and inspire students nationwide. His unique efforts even caught the attention of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who praised his work.

In recognition of his extraordinary contribution, Chandresh Borisagar received the National Teachers’ Award in 2024, a testament to his vision of making education accessible, enjoyable, and impactful for every child.

About Us

At Teachinghood, we support teachers and schools with practical resources, effective classroom strategies, and smooth hiring solutions. Our mission is to empower educators, improve teaching outcomes, and build a nurturing educational community across India. We aim to bridge the gap between talented teachers and quality institutions while fostering continuous learning, collaboration, and professional growth because strong educators create stronger schools.

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